



LIFE IN ACADEMIA AS A PHD STUDENT

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My Own Path

	Bachelor – Computer Science Cooperative study program with Mercedes Benz	📅 2015 – 2018
	Master – Artificial Intelligence Research Assistant positions	📅 2018 – 2020
	PhD – Artificial Intelligence ICAI Lab – Collaboration with Qualcomm Research	📅 Sep 2020 – now
	Research Intern AI4Science – Scientific Simulations	📅 Mar 2023 – May 2023
	Student Research Intern Deep Learning at Scale	📅 Aug 2023 – Nov 2023

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What will be your decision?

Decision: Academia vs Industry

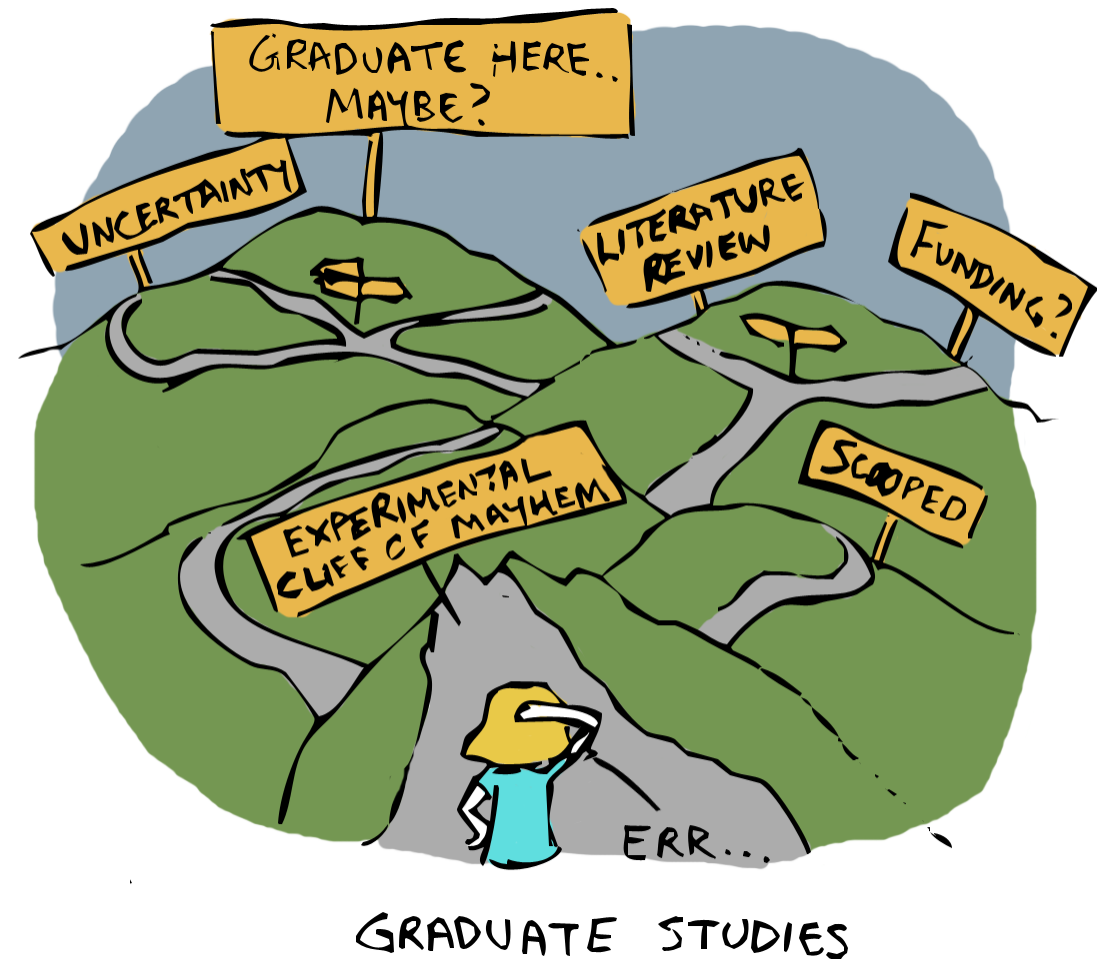
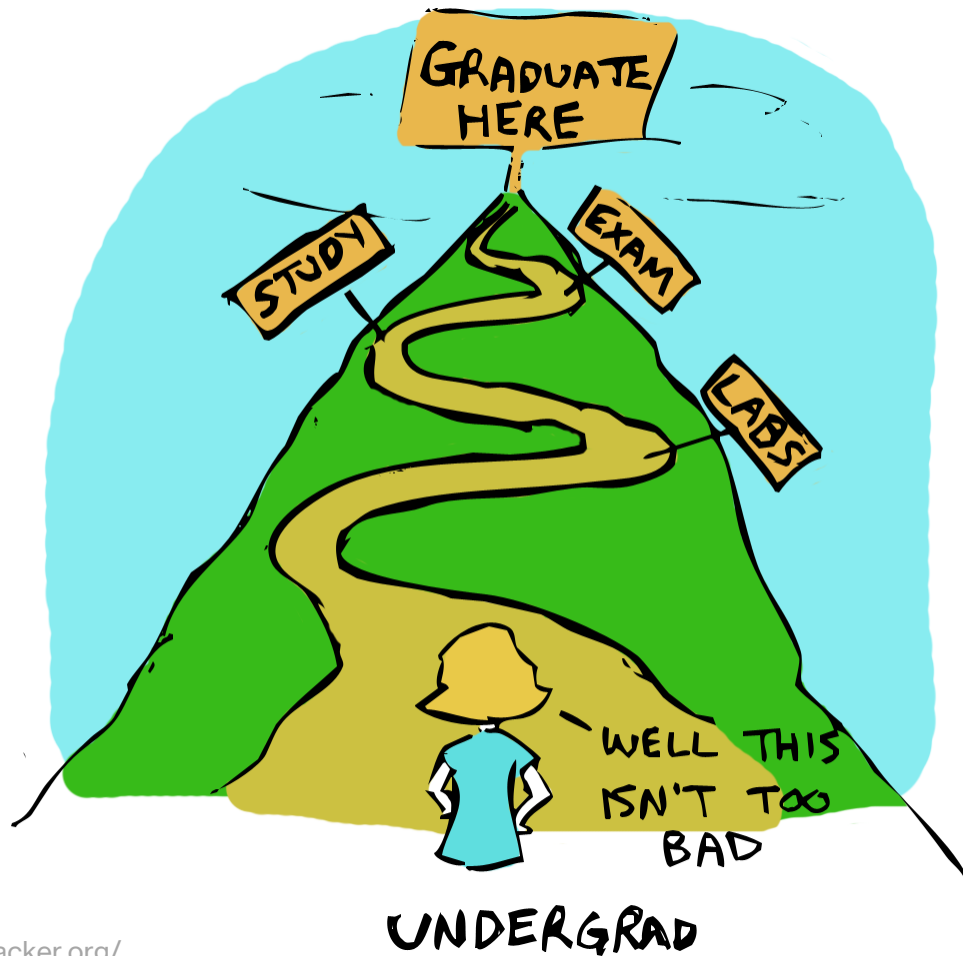
How Academia views Industry



How Industry views Academia



Freedom... but at what cost?



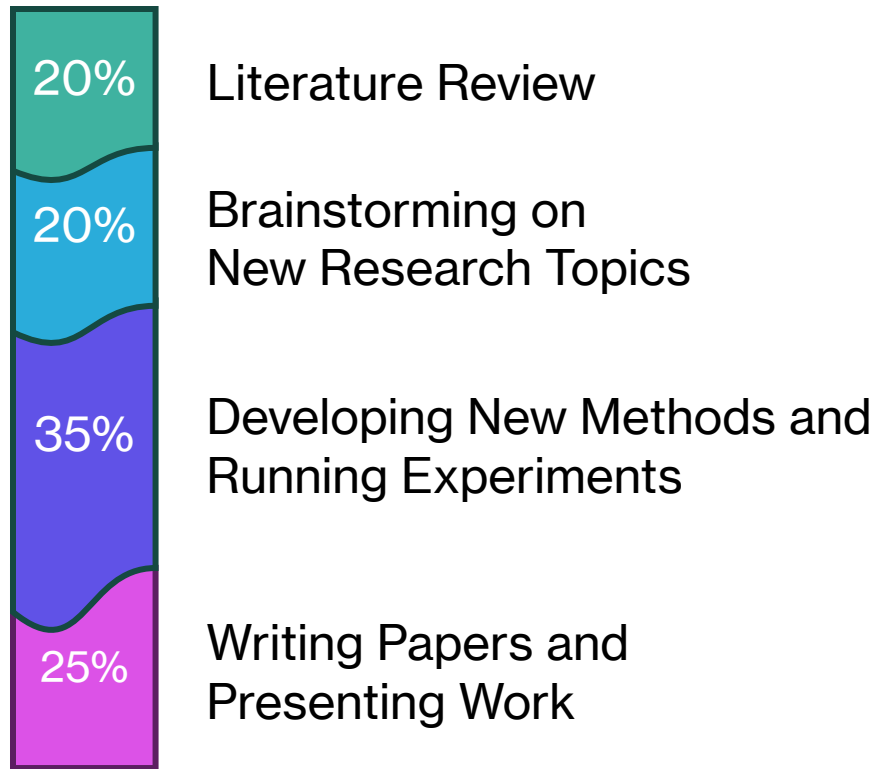
What does it mean to do a PhD?

The goal of the PhD is to write a thesis manuscript which “consists of a **scientific treatise** on a particular subject or a number of separate **scientific papers** that have been published”
[[UvA Doctorate Regulations](#)]

➡ **In AI:** 4 (ideally coherent) papers at top-tier conferences



Daily Life of a PhD Student



Additionally:

- Once a week: meeting with your supervisor(s)
- Casual conversations with your peers
- Teaching

Benefits

Traveling / International



Self-Development



Cutting edge



Sprouts in the shape of text 'Imagen' coming out of a fairytale book.



A photo of a Shiba Inu dog with a backpack riding a bike. It is wearing sunglasses and a beach hat.

Creativity



Drawbacks

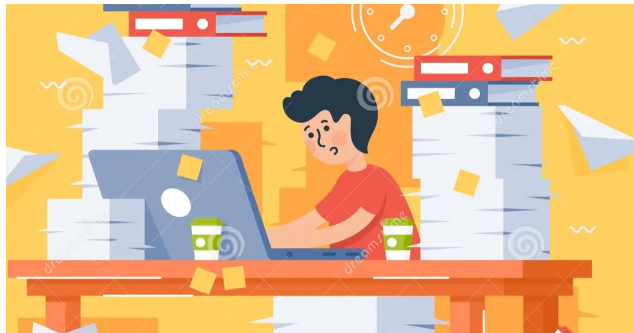
One-Person Job



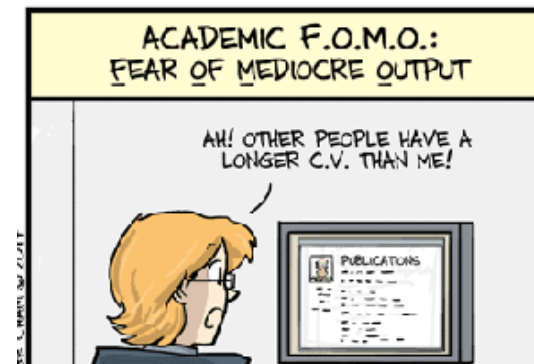
Stress



Workload



Pressure



— So... do you want to do a PhD?

- Gives you freedom for self-development and **your** research
- Different levels of industry relations possible (ICAI labs, industry PhD, etc.)
- A PhD opens up positions as researchers in industry (e.g. FAANG)

- Be aware that doing a PhD can be mentally challenging
- Most work done individually, collaborations often limited to advising
- Commitment for 3-4 years

Feel Free to Reach Out!



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Slides